



GSFA Online

Updated up to the 48th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (2025)

FOOD ADDITIVE GROUP DETAILS

HYDROXYBENZOATES, PARA-

The provisions that follow are defined at the additive group level, and thus apply to the *total* content of the additives participating in this group. Additives that make up this group are provided for reference only.

Participating Additive(s)

INS No. Additive Name

- 214 Ethyl para-hydroxybenzoate
- 218 Methyl para-hydroxybenzoate

CSV (Tables)

GSFA Provisions for HYDROXYBENZOATES, PARA-

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
14.2.7	Aromatized alcoholic beverages (e.g. beer, wine and spirituous cooler-type beverages, low alcoholic refreshers)	1,000 mg/kg	Note 224 Note 27
04.1.2.7	Candied fruit	1,000 mg/kg	Note 27
01.6.5	Cheese analogues	500 mg/kg	Note 27
05.3	Chewing gum	1,500 mg/kg	Note 27
14.2.2	Cider and perry	200 mg/kg	Note 27
05.1.3	Cocoa-based spreads, including fillings	300 mg/kg	Note XS86 Note 27
14.1.5	Coffee, coffee substitutes, tea, herbal infusions, and other hot cereal and grain beverages, excluding cocoa	450 mg/kg	Note 160 Note 27
05.2	Confectionery including hard and soft candy, nougats, etc. other than food categories 05.1, 05.3 and 05.4	1,000 mg/kg	Note XS309R Note 27
01.7	Dairy-based desserts (e.g. pudding, fruit or flavoured yoghurt)	120 mg/kg	Note 27 Note XS243
05.4	Decorations (e.g. for fine bakery wares), toppings (non-fruit) and sweet sauces	300 mg/kg	Note 27
04.1.2.2	Dried fruit	800 mg/kg	Note 27
08.4	Edible casings (e.g. sausage casings)	36 mg/kg	Note 27
02.3	Fat emulsions mainly of type oil-in-water, including mixed and/or flavoured products based on fat emulsions	300 mg/kg	Note 27
02.2.2	Fat spreads, dairy fat spreads and blended spreads	300 mg/kg	Note 27 Note XS256 Note XS253
04.1.2.10	Fermented fruit products	800 mg/kg	Note 27
04.2.2.7	Fermented vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera) and seaweed products, excluding fermented soybean products of food categories 06.8.6, 06.8.7, 12.9.1, 12.9.2.1 and 12.9.2.3	300 mg/kg	Note XS294 Note 27
07.2	Fine bakery wares (sweet, salty, savoury) and mixes	300 mg/kg	Note 27
04.1.2.11	Fruit fillings for pastries	800 mg/kg	Note 27
04.1.2.3	Fruit in vinegar, oil, or brine	250 mg/kg	Note 27
04.1.2.8	Fruit preparations, including pulp, purees, fruit toppings and coconut milk	800 mg/kg	Note XS314R Note 27

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 04.1.2.9	Fruit-based desserts, including fruit-flavoured water-based desserts	800 mg/kg	 Note 27
 04.1.2.6	Fruit-based spreads (e.g. chutney) excluding products of food category 04.1.2.5	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 27  Note 570
 05.1.5	Imitation chocolate, chocolate substitute products	300 mg/kg	 Note 27
 04.1.2.5	Jams, jellies, marmelades	250 mg/kg	 Note 27
 14.2.5	Mead	200 mg/kg	 Note 27
 12.4	Mustards	300 mg/kg	 Note 27
 11.4	Other sugars and syrups (e.g. xylose, maple syrup, sugar toppings)	100 mg/kg	 Note 27
 01.6.4	Processed cheese	300 mg/kg	 Note 27
 15.2	Processed nuts, including coated nuts and nut mixtures (with e.g. dried fruit)	300 mg/kg	 Note 27
 12.6	Sauces and like products	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS302  Note 27
 09.3	Semi-preserved fish and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS291  Note 27
 15.1	Snacks - potato, cereal, flour or starch based (from roots and tubers, pulses and legumes)	300 mg/kg	 Note 27
 04.2.2.6	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed pulps and preparations (e.g. vegetable desserts and sauces, candied vegetables) other than food category 04.2.2.5	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS308R  Note 27  Note XS259R  Note XS57
 04.2.2.5	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed purees and spreads (e.g., peanut butter)	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 27  Note XS57
 04.2.2.3	Vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), and seaweeds in vinegar, oil, brine, or soybean sauce	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 27
 12.3	Vinegars	100 mg/kg	 Note 27
 14.1.4	Water-based flavoured drinks, including "sport," "energy," or "electrolyte" drinks and particulated drinks	500 mg/kg	 Note 27
 14.2.4	Wines (other than grape)	200 mg/kg	 Note 27

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

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